

CYBR Z Technical Challenge #01

Submission Guide

Your submission should show how you reached your conclusions, not only what conclusion you reached.

What You Need to Submit

Prepare the following:

1. Your initial incident verdict
 2. Your confidence level
 3. Your evidence-based reasoning
 4. Your response to any additional evidence released later
 5. Your VPN / ZTNA / Hybrid architecture decision
 6. Your immediate response and longer-term security recommendations
 7. Your final four-slide presentation
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Initial Incident Verdict

Choose one:

- Legitimate
- Suspicious
- Compromised

Confidence:

- Low
- Medium
- High

Your reasoning should clearly separate:

- confirmed observations
- reasonable inferences
- assumptions
- unresolved questions

Do not present an assumption as a fact.

Evidence Analysis

Your analysis should use the supplied evidence as a combined dataset.

At minimum, identify:

- important timestamps
- authentication events
- MFA activity
- VPN session activity
- internal resource access
- user baseline context
- endpoint context
- relationships between the evidence sources

Where two sources appear inconsistent, explain the inconsistency rather than ignoring it.

You may use tables, diagrams or a short timeline if they help make your reasoning clearer.

Additional Evidence

If additional evidence is released, keep your original conclusion visible.

Then state whether you:

- Maintain
- Revise
- Withdraw

your original position.

Explain:

- which new evidence mattered
- what it changed
- what it did not change
- how your confidence changed

A revised conclusion is not a failure.

Changing your position for a defensible reason is part of good security analysis.

Architecture Decision

Your final recommendation must select:

- VPN
- ZTNA
- Hybrid

Do not make the decision only at product-label level.

Explain which control model should apply to different access scenarios, including where relevant:

- managed remote employees
- contractors and BYOD
- internal web applications
- legacy services

- privileged access
- emergency access

Your recommendation should address:

- identity
 - device trust
 - least privilege
 - access segmentation
 - session context
 - logging
 - detection
 - operational constraints
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Presentation Requirements

Maximum:

4 slides

Presentation duration:

5 minutes

Recommended structure:

Slide 1 — What Happened?

Timeline, verdict and confidence.

Slide 2 — What Does the Evidence Tell Us?

Key evidence, contradictions and gaps.

Slide 3 — VPN, ZTNA or Hybrid?

Architecture decision and justification.

Slide 4 — What Should We Do Next?

Immediate response, detection and longer-term improvements.

A short jury / CTO Q&A will follow the presentation.

Presentation Guidance

Do:

- prioritise the strongest evidence
- keep the timeline readable
- make your conclusion explicit
- explain uncertainty
- defend your architecture decision
- make recommendations actionable

Avoid:

- copying raw logs into slides
 - filling slides with paragraphs
 - presenting every artefact equally
 - hiding evidence that weakens your argument
 - using technology terms without explaining why they matter
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Use of AI

AI-assisted tools may be used to support:

- organising notes
- improving presentation structure
- reviewing wording
- exploring alternative hypotheses

However, the final technical judgement, evidence interpretation and presentation must remain your own.

You are responsible for every claim you submit.

During the jury / CTO Q&A, you may be asked to explain how you reached a specific conclusion.

Evidence Integrity

Do not modify the supplied evidence files.

If you make working copies for notes or analysis, keep the original evidence unchanged.

The supplied SHA256SUMS.txt file can be used to confirm evidence integrity.

Final Submission Check

Before submitting, confirm that you can answer:

1. What happened?
2. What evidence supports my conclusion?
3. What evidence weakens my conclusion?
4. What am I still uncertain about?
5. Did new evidence change my decision?
6. Why did I choose VPN, ZTNA or Hybrid?
7. What should the organisation do immediately?
8. What should it change for the future?
9. Can I defend all of this in five minutes?

If you cannot answer one of these clearly, your analysis is not finished.